

Durably Green & Social Claims Risk Scan

Detailed methodology - v44 | Pre-publication claim-risk engine for environmental and social claims

This methodology explains how the scan identifies, classifies and scores potentially risky green and social claims in websites, product pages, campaign pages, packaging/brochure pages and internal documents. The tool is an indicative first-pass screening mechanism: it supports legal, compliance, sustainability and communication review, but it does not provide legal advice and does not establish that greenwashing or social washing occurred.

1. Regulatory and standards framework

The scan applies a structured claim-governance lens based on the following frameworks:

Framework	How it is used in the scan
Directive (EU) 2024/825 - Empowering Consumers for the Green Transition (EmpCo)	Primary lens for consumer-facing environmental claims. The scan checks generic green wording, climate/offset claims, labels, future performance claims, comparisons, durability/repairability and claims presented before, during or after a commercial transaction.
Unfair Commercial Practices Directive (UCPD), as amended by EmpCo	Used to assess whether wording, visuals, labels, brand names, trade names or presentation may mislead the average consumer on environmental, social or circularity characteristics.
Green Claims Directive proposal	Used as a best-practice substantiation lens while its legislative status remains separate from EmpCo. The scan uses its logic of robust, science-based and verifiable substantiation, clear communication and transparent labels.
Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 - Forced Labour Regulation	Used for product, supplier, import/export, traceability, modern-slavery and forced-labour claims. The scan looks for wording that implies assurance without evidence of forced-labour risk assessment, supplier/product traceability, mitigation, remediation and response readiness.
CSRD / ESRS, OECD Guidelines, UNGPs, ILO, UNGC and GRI	Used as supporting standards for social claims, human-rights due diligence, worker and value-chain claims, affected communities, consumers/end-users, grievance/remedy and balanced reporting.

Current-status note: EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825 is the central binding reference for the scan and enters into application on 27 September 2026. The EU Forced Labour Regulation applies from 14 December 2027. The Green Claims Directive proposal is treated as a substantiation best-practice lens, not as the same legal basis as EmpCo.

2. Scope, channels and sources

- **Website scan:** reviews the submitted URL and a limited number of related company pages where technically reachable.
- **Document scan:** reviews only the uploaded document; it is not combined with website content or external public-source signals.
- **Channel classification:** client-facing material receives stricter EmpCo-style scrutiny; investor reports and internal policies are treated mainly as evidence or consistency sources.
- **Claim source traceability:** each detected claim is linked to the reviewed page, document or source URL where possible.
- **Visual signals:** image alt text, icon names, badge classes and semantic cues are scanned where available. The tool flags visual green cues such as leaf, eco, planet, recycled, carbon, climate or sustainability badges, but manual visual review remains necessary.

3. Claim taxonomy

Green claim module	Examples of signals
Generic environmental claims	green, eco, environmentally friendly, sustainable, planet friendly, biobased, climate-friendly
Climate / offsetting claims	carbon neutral, climate neutral, net zero product, climate positive, offset, compensated emissions
Circularity / durability / recyclability	recyclable, recycled content, circular, reusable, repairable, biodegradable, compostable
Comparative environmental claims	lower emissions, less harmful, greener than, more sustainable than, best environmental

Labels, icons and certification claims	eco label, green choice, certified, verified, badge, leaf/tree/planet/water-drop visual cues
Future environmental performance	net-zero ambition, climate roadmap, by 2030/2040/2050, transition plan, science-based target
Social claims	ethical, responsible, human rights, labour rights, forced labour free, responsible sourcing, supplier code, living wage, inclusion, safe workplace, accessibility

4. Score calculation method

The scan produces three scores: **Global risk score**, **Green risk score** and **Social risk score**. Scores are risk indicators from 0 to 100; higher means higher need for review, substantiation and safer wording.

Component	Green score	Social score	Weight / role
Claim wording risk	Sensitivity of wording under EmpCo modules: generic, climate/offsetting, label/icon, future, comparative, legal-requirement or absolute wording.	Sensitivity of social wording: human rights, forced labour, supplier, labour, D&I, safety, customer/accessibility or absolute coverage claims.	30%
Substantiation / evidence-gap risk	Whether same-medium specification, scope, methodology, data, verification, limitations and evidence are present.	Whether scope, KPIs, reporting period, stakeholder coverage, due diligence, grievance/remedy, audit coverage, traceability and limitations are present.	30%
External public-source context	Retained external sources indicating greenwashing, misleading claims, regulator/ad complaint, litigation or stakeholder criticism. Company-owned reports are excluded from this bucket.	Retained external sources indicating labour, human-rights, supplier, discrimination, safety, customer-protection or forced-labour concerns. Company-owned reports are excluded from this bucket.	25%
Sector/channel sensitivity	Environmental intensity and B2C/consumer-facing relevance.	Sector exposure to labour, value-chain, vulnerable stakeholder or customer risks.	15%

Global score. The global score is a conservative integrated risk view based on the green and social scores. It is capped so it does not exceed the highest dimension score. This avoids presenting a high global risk where only one dimension has limited signals.

Score caps and uplifts. High scores normally require problematic wording plus evidence gaps and/or relevant external contradiction. Direct EmpCo blacklisted-practice indicators can raise the green score even without external controversy, because the legal risk can arise from the claim wording itself. Direct forced-labour, product, supplier or traceability claims can raise the social score where evidence is insufficient.

5. Risk interpretation

Score band	Interpretation
0-29	Low claim-risk signal. Maintain evidence file and standard review.
30-49	Potentially overbroad claim. Improve scope, specificity and substantiation.
50-69	Material review needed. Claim may be too broad, insufficiently evidenced or sensitive for the channel.
70-84	High risk. Legal/compliance and evidence review recommended before publication or reuse.
85-100	Very high risk. Strong claim wording, major evidence gap and/or strong contradiction/regulatory signals. Escalate urgently.

6. Evidence file expectations

For each priority claim, the company should maintain a claim evidence file. The minimum file includes: approved claim wording, source page/document, internal owner, date, intended audience, scope, methodology, data sources, KPIs, reporting period, limitations, verification/certification evidence, review status and next review date.

- For climate claims: emissions scopes, baseline, actual reductions versus offsets, residual emissions, transition plan, methodology and verification.
- For labels and icons: scheme owner, certification criteria, independence, audit/verification basis, validity period and scope.

- For comparative claims: comparator, equivalent basis, methodology, source data, update mechanism and limitations.
- For supplier/human-rights claims: supplier tiers, coverage, risk assessment, audit quality, worker voice, grievance/remedy, corrective-action closure and traceability.
- For forced-labour claims: product/supplier traceability, geographic/product risk assessment, prevention/mitigation, remediation, disengagement criteria and withdrawal/customs response readiness.

7. External public-source signals

External public-source signals are scanned separately for green and social risks. The tool searches for third-party sources such as regulators, courts, authorities, NGOs, civil-society organisations, media and public complaints. Company-owned websites, sustainability reports, policies, supplier codes and annual reports are excluded from the external signal bucket; they may be evidence but not independent contradiction signals.

External results are retained only when they are negative or risk-relevant and appear to refer to the concrete company, brand or alias. For groups such as Inditex/Zara, brand aliases are used to improve recall. All external signals require manual verification before being relied on.

8. Limitations and manual review

- The scan is not legal advice and does not establish legal breach, greenwashing or social washing.
- Website crawling may miss dynamic content, PDFs behind scripts, images without useful alt text, videos, social media and pages blocked by robots or security settings.
- Visual claims are only partially detected through available HTML cues. Packaging and campaign visuals require manual review or image-based review.
- External-source quality depends on configured search providers and available snippets. Absence of retained signals is not proof that no controversy exists.
- Scores are calibrated for prioritisation and pre-publication governance, not for public ESG rating or assurance.

9. Key references

- European Commission - FAQ on Empowering Consumers for the Green Transition Directive, 18 May 2026.
- European Commission - Sustainable consumption and Directive (EU) 2024/825: entry into application on 27 September 2026.
- European Commission - Green Claims initiative: substantiation and communication of explicit environmental claims using robust, science-based and verifiable methods.
- EUR-Lex - Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 on prohibiting products made with forced labour on the Union market.
- European Commission - Forced Labour Regulation: ban on products made with forced labour; rules apply from 14 December 2027.
- OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises, UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, ILO Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work, UN Global Compact and GRI Standards.